The 6:15

SUNDAY · OCTOBER 4, 2026 NO. 23

THE BOARD

CALENDAR · WEEKEND FORMAT, COLLAPSED

This week	Sun 10/4 OPEC+ 68th JMMC meeting **(no outcome reported as of writing)**. Mon 10/5 Knicks preseason opens at Philadelphia. Tue 10/14, 8:30a ET: September CPI. Wed 10/15, 8:30a ET: September PPI.
Standing	FOMC next meets Oct. 27-28. Funding runs on the Dec. 11 CR; FY27 began Oct. 1 without incident. US-China truce to Jan. 10 unchanged. Yankees-Rays ALDS continues; next game date **not confirmed this run**.

Weekend format: calendar collapsed to two lines per masthead convention.

METRICS · FRI 10/2 CLOSE/SETTLE, ET UNLESS NOTED

Oil / rates / FX	Brent $102.72 (Dec contract, ICE, +0.46%). WTI **not confirmed this run**. 10Y 5.28% / 2Y 4.84%, both +~5bp after an early post-release dip reversed by the close; 30Y **not reconfirmed**. DXY 101.93 (-0.17%).
Equities / other	S&P +0.7%, Nasdaq +1.2% to a record 27,191, Dow +0.5%. VIX **not confirmed this run**. Gold spiked ~1% to ~$4,217 at the 8:30a release **(Friday settle not reconfirmed)**. Asia: Nikkei 68,309.46 (-0.94%); Hang Seng 23,972.29 (-2.60%). Europe **not verified this run**. AAA gas **not reconfirmed; carries 9/28's $4.4768/gal**.

The post-jobs-report round-trip in rates — down on the 8:30a release, higher by the close — is described in the Lead. Treat gold's intraday spike and Friday's final settle as two different numbers.

HORMUZ COUNTERS

Strikes, 24h	1 tanker struck by unidentified projectile Thu. 10/1 (UKMTO), fire resulted, crew safe **(no further incident confirmed)**
Transits	1 on Sept. 27 vs. 85/day baseline (IMF PortWatch) — still the most recent published day, no newer figure

	located
Vessels holding	135 AIS-visible, 23:50 UTC Sept. 30 (issue No. 22, carried) **— no newer count located; whether the drop held is unconfirmed**
War-risk premia	~10% hull value fleet-wide; ~$10M/transit on a $100M tanker **(carried from issue No. 21; straits.live feed still degraded)**

Methodology: transit counts (PortWatch, lagged), AIS vessel-holding counts (same-day volatility) and war-risk premia (insurance-market reporting, periodic) measure different things over different windows and vendors; never averaged or differenced here.

TRANSACTIONS

Yankees	Lost ALDS Gm 1 1-0 at Tampa Bay Sat 10/3 (Aranda HR off Cole; Rasmussen 10 K/8 IP); series 0-1. Next game date **not confirmed this run**.
Knicks	No reported moves in the last 24 hours; preseason opens Mon. 10/5 at Philadelphia.
Northwestern	Beat Penn State 22-21 Fri. 10/2 at Ryan Field; improves to 3-1.

LEAD

LABOR MARKET — A SECOND SOFT PRINT, A ONE-WAY MARKET REACTION

September payrolls add just 29,000 — the week's second straight soft print pushes the Fed to the sidelines and stocks to records, but Hormuz keeps a floor under oil

Friday's jobs report was the week's second consecutive data point to break sharply dovish. The Bureau of Labor Statistics said nonfarm payrolls rose just 29,000 in September, against consensus estimates clustered in the 84,000-90,000 range across trackers — one of the larger misses of the cycle. [fact] The unemployment rate rose to 4.2% from 4.1%. [fact] July and August were revised down by a combined 60,000, with August cut from an initially reported 162,000 to 133,000. [fact] Coming four days after Wednesday's cooler-than-

expected August PCE print (this brief's Thursday lead), the two releases together have done more to reshape the rate-hike debate than anything since the Sept. 16 hike itself. [read]

The market reaction was immediate and one-directional, unlike Thursday's split verdict between a dovish PCE and a Hormuz-driven crude rally. CME FedWatch's probability of a quarter-point hike at the Oct. 27-28 meeting collapsed to roughly 17%, with the probability of a hold near 83% — down from Thursday's already-reduced ~35% and from above 70% a week earlier. [fact] December remains the market's preferred timing for the next hike, with FedWatch showing north of 75% odds there, per one tracker. [fact, single-sourced]

Equities took the "bad data, dovish Fed" read and ran with it: the S&P 500 gained 0.7%, the Dow 0.5%, and the Nasdaq Composite 1.2% to a fresh record close of 27,191, with chipmakers and megacaps leading — the Philadelphia semiconductor index firmed over 3%, and Nvidia touched an intraday record, up roughly 2.5%. [fact] That is a continuation of Thursday's resilience, where stocks held up even as oil and the PCE data pulled in opposite directions. [read]

Bonds told a more complicated story than the headline suggests. Treasury yields fell immediately on the 8:30a release, as the market priced out hike risk, but reversed over the session: the 10-year and 2-year both finished roughly 5 basis points higher on the day, at 5.28% and 4.84% respectively. [fact] That intraday round-trip — lower on the data, higher by the close — suggests the initial flight-to-duration bid gave way to concerns the miss reflects deeper labor-market softening than a one-off, or simply that a market already positioned for a dovish Fed found less reason to extend the rally in rates once

the number was in hand. [read] The dollar index eased modestly to 101.93 (-0.17%), and gold spiked about 1% intraday to roughly $4,217 before giving back some of that move. [fact]

Crude sits apart from this story, as it did Thursday. Brent settled Friday at $102.72 on the active ICE contract, still elevated, with no clean WTI settle located this run. [fact/flag] A weaker-dollar, lower-rates backdrop would ordinarily support crude on its own, but the more immediate driver remains the Strait of Hormuz, where UKMTO confirmed another tanker struck by an unidentified projectile Thursday, this one causing a fire. [fact] With no new data this run on transit counts or vessel-holding levels to confirm whether late-September's attack spike and the sharp vessel-count drop have stabilized, oil's risk premium looks unresolved rather than receding. [read]

Stakes heading into the week: a Fed that now has real cover to hold on Oct. 27-28 unless the picture changes again before Oct. 14's CPI and Oct. 15's PPI — both of which just gained weight given how far two data points moved the odds in four trading days. Today's OPEC+ JMMC meeting could add a second, oil-specific variable on top of the Hormuz risk premium; no outcome is in yet. [flag] Whether Thursday's UKMTO incident is a one-off or the start of a fresh escalation cycle, and whether Tehran's review of Washington's counter-proposal (Iran & Hormuz, below) produces any public signal before markets reopen, are the two threads most likely to move Monday's open.

ECONOMICS

Thursday's September ISM Manufacturing PMI came in at 54.6, below the 55.2 consensus on one tracker not independently cross-

verified this run. [flag, single-sourced] Combined with Friday's payrolls miss, the data flow this week points toward a softer, not stronger, economy than the Sept. 16 hike was predicated on — raising the question of whether the Fed's tightening cycle is already done, rather than merely paused for one meeting. [read] CPI (Oct. 14) and PPI (Oct. 15) now carry more weight than they would have a week ago: a core CPI print anywhere near consensus would likely cement the October hold already priced in; a hot one would revive the hike debate on short notice. No fresh Fed-speak responding directly to Friday's number was located this run. [flag]

BUSINESS

Nike's fiscal Q1 2027 results, released Thursday after the close, were a large beat: diluted EPS of $0.72 against a consensus of $0.13, and revenue of $10.97B versus $10.85B expected (+1.09%). [fact] The headline number is distorted by a one-time, non-operating item — a $986M benefit tied to the expected recovery of IEEPA tariffs following a US action — so the clean comparison to the ~50% Vietnam-sourcing/46% tariff exposure flagged in prior issues is harder to read off the EPS line alone. [fact/flag] The company's "Pace" operating-model transformation, announced alongside results, extends Nike's beat streak to seven straight quarters on consensus EPS. [fact] No tariff-margin guidance update beyond the one-time item was located this run. [flag]

GEOPOLITICS

Russia launched a large overnight barrage at Ukraine between 10/3 and 10/4: 109 Shahed-type and other strike drones plus three Iskander-M/KN-23 ballistic missiles, per the Ukrainian Air Force. [NEW, fact] Ukrainian air defense reported shooting down or suppressing 73 drones; three missiles and 36 drones still struck 21 locations. Chernihiv Oblast took the heaviest hit, with power infrastructure damaged and roughly 50,000 customers losing electricity. [fact] No new confirmed Houthi-Saudi exchange located since Sept. 26 (issue No. 20); the Makkah Joint Defense Agreement stands unchanged. [continuity]

IRAN & HORMUZ

Beyond Thursday's tanker fire (Board), there is no public update this run on Tehran's review of Washington's Qatari-mediated counter-proposal, which Foreign Minister Araghchi was reported carrying to Iran's Cabinet as of Wednesday (issue No. 22). [continuity, flag] Neither side has disclosed terms, and no search this run surfaced a fresher statement from either Araghchi or the White House on where that review stands heading into the weekend. [flag] The practical read: the diplomatic track is neither confirmed dead nor confirmed advancing — it is simply quiet, which given the pattern of this conflict is not itself informative either way. [read]

On the physical side, Thursday's fire-causing strike is this run's only confirmed new incident; it does not by itself establish whether late September's attack cluster (three tankers Sept. 30, the Kuwaiti-flagged Al Funtas Sept. 28, the Sept. 23 Cape Dao torpedo attack with one death) is continuing at the same pace or tapering. [flag]

Vessel-holding and transit data remain unrefreshed since issue No. 22 and No. 19/20 respectively (Board), so no trend claim — easing or escalating — is supportable from this run's data alone. [flag]

SPORTS

Yankees	Lost ALDS Gm 1 1-0 at Tampa Bay Sat. 10/3 (Aranda HR off Cole; Rasmussen 10 K/8 IP); series 0-1. Next game date **not confirmed this run**.
Knicks	No reported moves in the last 24 hours. Preseason opens Mon. 10/5 at Philadelphia.
Northwestern	Beat Penn State 22-21 Fri. 10/2 at Ryan Field; improves to 3-1. Next game **not independently verified this run**.

Continuity. Cut from issue No. 22 as unmoved: Politics (nothing new located this run) and Technology (no frontier-AI release, rocket launch, or major VC round confirmed this run) — both dropped rather than padded. Not refreshed this run: WTI settle, 30Y yield, VIX, gold's exact Friday settle, European closes, AAA gas, Hormuz transit/vessel-holding counts, and war-risk premia. Watch for next issue: whether Tehran's review of the US counter-proposal produces any public signal; today's OPEC+ JMMC outcome; whether Thursday's tanker-fire incident is isolated or the start of a new attack cluster; the next Yankees-Rays ALDS game; and whether December's >75% hike odds hold up against Oct. 14-15 CPI/PPI.

Unverified figures are marked in red above. WTI settle, 30Y yield and VIX not located; gold's exact Friday settle (only the post-release spike is sourced); FTSE/DAX/CAC closes not located; AAA gas carried from 9/28; Hormuz transit and vessel-holding counts both carried stale; war-risk premia carried from issue No. 21; ISM PMI consensus and December hike odds both single-sourced; the next ALDS game date not located cleanly this run. Nothing was estimated or filled from memory.